

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: It's time to write an e-mail to a contact!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe jobs and careers in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever sent an e-mail to someone you don't know in order to get information or ask for something? Who was that person? What was it for?
- What should you include when writing an e-mail?

Can Do Statements

- I can write descriptions about professional information.
- I can write an e-mail for a networking contact.
- I can write about actions related to my career plans.





Let's Explore!

Kristi sends an e-mail to a contact she was **referred to***. Does she get a reply?

* To "be referred to" means to be suggested by someone else.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

From: k.lenard@mail.com
To: danielle_wilkinson@WXBJ.com
Subject: Request for Informational Interview – Harvard Alumni

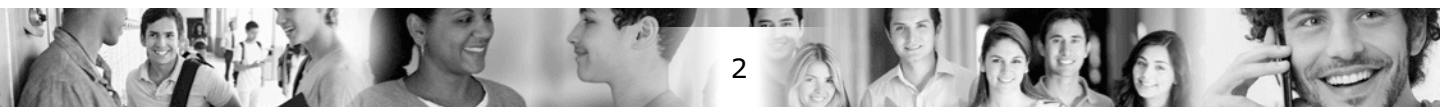
Dear Ms. Wilkinson,
After receiving your contact information from my mother, I thought I would get in touch. She mentioned that you received your Bachelor of Arts in Communications from Harvard before beginning your career at WXBJ-FM. I also graduated from Harvard with a BA in English in May 2008 and since graduating, I have interned as a copy editor with Polygon. Over the past two years, I have also written content for social media, as well as worked with the CEO developing an offline marketing campaign. Although I have enjoyed my role at Polygon, I hope to leverage the organizational, communication and analytical skills I have developed here to obtain a more challenging position. I feel I can make a difference in an organization and would like the chance to do that.
I would appreciate any advice or suggestions that you might have to offer. Would it be possible for you to set aside 20 to 30 minutes to talk to me at your convenience to further explore this industry? I look forward to hearing from you.
Sincerely,
Kristi Lenard

From: danielle_wilkinson@WXBJ.com
To: k.lenard@mail.com
Subject: RE: Request for Informational Interview – Harvard Alumni

Dear Ms. Lenard,
Thank you for reaching out to me. I would love to sit down to talk to you. Please let me know what time works for you next week.
Regards,
Danielle Wilkinson

From: k.lenard@mail.com
To: danielle_wilkinson@WXBJ.com
Subject: RE: RE: Request for Informational Interview – Harvard Alumni

Dear Ms. Wilkinson,
Thank you for getting back to me and being willing to chat with me. Over the next week, I am free after 1 p.m. on Monday and Tuesday afternoons as well as all day on Wednesday. Will any of those times work for you?
Thank you again,
Kristi





Let's Practice!

What words does Kristi use in her e-mail when requesting an informational interview?

Instructions: Complete the text below by choosing from the options you are given.

1. Graduation - alumni - referral
2. Certificate of - Degree of - Bachelor of
3. Was interning - have interned - intern
4. Informational interview - contact information - marketing campaign
5. leveraging - obtaining - communicating
6. utilize - obtain - dictate
7. dive in - explore farther - further explore

From: k.lenard@mail.com

To: danielle_wilkinson@WXBj.com

Subject: Request for Informational Interview – Harvard

Dear Ms. Wilkinson,

I was given your contact information by my mother. She mentioned that you received your _____ Arts in Communications from Harvard before beginning your career at WXBj-FM. I also graduated from Harvard with a BA in English in May 2008 and since graduating I _____ as a copy editor with Polygon. Over the past two years, I have also written content for social media and worked with the CEO in developing an offline _____. Although I enjoyed my role, I am interested in _____ the strong organizational, communication and analytical skills that I've developed to _____ a position where I can have a more direct impact on an organization.

I would really appreciate it if we could set up a 20 to 30 minute meeting, at your convenience, to discuss any advice and suggestions that you might have as I _____ this industry. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely, Kristi Lenard





Let's Practice!

Now, it's your turn to write an e-mail requesting an informational interview.

Instructions: You have to write an e-mail to a professional at an advertising agency requesting an informational interview.

1. Write a 200 - 250 word e-mail to a professional.
2. Include your e-mail address and their e-mail address.
3. Include a subject line, salutation, summary, request and a closing.
4. Use gerunds to describe actions like learning.
5. Write in formal language and in complete sentences.

• My E-mail Request for an Informational Interview

• From: _____

• To: _____

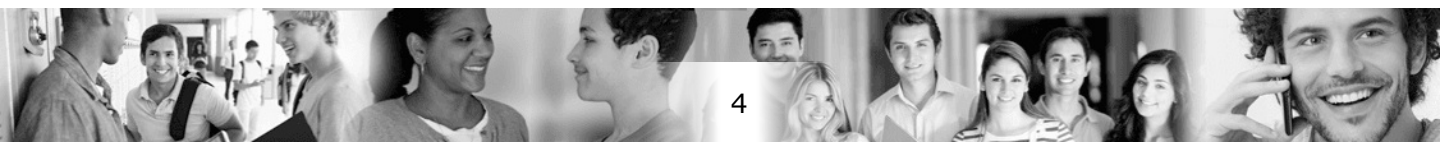
• Subject: _____

• Salutation: _____

• Summary: _____

• Making the Request: _____

• Closing: _____





Extension Activity

Write an e-mail requesting an informational interview.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find the contact information of someone you would like to have an informational interview with.
- Write a rough draft of an e-mail you would send him/her requesting an informational interview. Use gerunds.
- Proofread your e-mail. Read it aloud to a partner.
- Send your e-mail.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write an e-mail for a networking contact.

☐ ☐

I include the different parts of an e-mail.

☐ ☐

I use gerunds in my e-mail.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- alumni** (noun): people who used to attend an educational institution
Example: Subject: Request for Informational Interview – Harvard Alumni
- Bachelor of** (expression): refers to an undergraduate degree from a college or university
e.g. My boss obtained a Bachelor of Arts in Communications.
- to intern** (verb): to work for practical experience instead of salary
e.g. I have interned as a copy editor with Polygon.
- marketing campaign** (noun): a series of steps to promote a product using a variety of different types of advertisements
e.g. I developed an offline marketing campaign.
- to leverage** (verb): to apply something (knowledge, skill, time, etc.) in order to receive a high rate of return
e.g. I hope to leverage the organizational, communication and analytical skills I have developed here to obtain a more challenging position.
- to obtain** (verb): to get something through your own effort, skill, or work
e.g. I would like to obtain a more challenging position.
- further explore** (expression): investigate something in more detail or depth
e.g. Can I meet with you to talk and further explore this industry?





Learning Points

Writing an E-mail

In the Business world, there will be many times when you need to write an e-mail. The reason for writing an e-mail will vary. However the format of an e-mail will stay the same.

An e-mail should always include:

- Subject Line
- Salutation
- Body
- Closing
- Signature

Example:

Subject: Request for Informational Interview

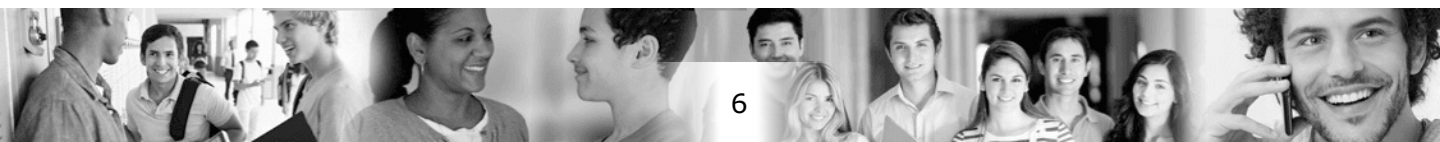
Dear Mr. Smith,

I received your contact information from my mentor, Jane Doe, who said that you would be a great person to connect with in regards to _____. I was hoping to gain some insight on _____ and _____.

I am a graduate of Boston University working/interested in _____. Is there a possibility that we could connect for 15 minutes over the phone?

Thank you for your time and I look forward to hearing from you.

*Regards,
Miley Moe*





Learning Points

Using Gerunds in E-mails

When you are writing an e-mail to a networking contact you may use **gerunds**.

Gerunds can be used as the subject, the complement or the object of your sentence. They can also be the object of the **preposition** in your sentence.

For example:

I am e-mailing you about setting up a meeting.

Preposition	Example
after	After looking for some time, I came across your profile.
before	Before making a change, I wanted to talk to someone in the industry.
by	I wanted to start by thanking you.
for	Thank you for getting back to me.
in	I am interested in switching careers.
since	Since finishing school, I have worked in the retail industry.

